Joanna Rob

SE16 7TR, London, England | +44 7742445695 | asia.rob@ucl.ac.uk | www.linkedin.com/in/joannarob

Profile and research interests

Joanna is an Associate Lecturer of English for Academic Purposes at UCL in London with extensive experience working in the Higher Education sector in the UK. With a diverse professional background as a former actress and dancer, she seeks to integrate her academic and creative industries' background with her passion for teaching and research, aiming to foster inclusion and multicultural collaboration within postcolonial and decolonial frameworks.

She has a particular interest in helping to improve the treatment of creative (international) professionals in the creative industries and exploring how resources can be distributed to help them improve their employability skills. She further plans to undertake a PhD research project focused on applying linguistics frameworks (discourse and conversation analysis) to explore how power is distributed and used by producers and directors in negotiating contracts and employing actors in the UK and India.

Education

CELTA | DEC 2022 | INTERNATIONAL HOUSE WROCLAW

Pass B.

M.A. IN ORIENTAL PHILOLOGY – SOUTH ASIAN STUDIES | OCT 2021 | JAGIELLONIAN UNIVERSITY IN CRACOW, POLAND

First class degree.

Title of the thesis: A novel as a genre of historical writing in India. The representation of Aurangzeb in Kitne Pākistān by Kamleshwar.

Areas of interest: Historiography; Translation practice; Orientalism and Occidentalism.

B.A. IN INTERNATIONAL MARKETING | JUNE 2016 | UNIVERSITY OF WESTMINSTER, LONDON, ENGLAND

2:1.

Modules: International Marketing; Cross Cultural Studies; Communications; Social media management.

Extracurricular activities: Social media management for the Student's Union; Social media internship at the UK Coffee Week; Hosting and presenting a radio show “Namaste Bollywood”; Content creation and marketing activities for the London Indian Film Festival.

HISTORY AND PRACTICE OF CINEMA | LOVELY PROFESSIONAL UNIVERSITY | JALANDHAR, INDIA | SEP 2016

The course was organized by the British Council and involved a range of lectures on the history of cinema and the practice of filmmaking delivered by the Lovely Professional University. The course culminated in a short film project *Burnt Feet* which Joanna worked on as a writer, choreographer and actor.

Skills & Abilities

- Lecture, workshop and teacher training design and delivery both face-to-face and using a range of online tools.
- Full working proficiency in three languages (English, Polish and Hindi) and a limited working proficiency in Spanish.
- Basic skills in Photography.
- Design and execution of Knowledge Exchange and Special Interest sessions for foreign language students, including Critical Thinking and Media and Journalism.
- Dance and performance.
- Event management, operations and administration.

Research interests

- Creative industries
- Exoticism, orientalism and occidentalism.
- Representations of cultural difference.
- Social justice and reparations.
- Narrative ethnography.
- Performance studies.
- South Asian Studies.
- Transnational media.
- Ethnographic studies.
- Andragogical and pedagogical practice.
- Didactic methodologies for learning.
- ESL/ EAP teaching practices.

Work experience

ASSOCIATE LECTURER IN ENGLISH FOR ACADEMIC PURPOSES | UNIVERSITY COLLEGE LONDON | JUL 2025 – SEP 2025

- Plan and deliver up to 21 hours of effective and engaging face-to-face lessons which develop the academic skills and language for up to 15 pre-postgraduate students.
- Complete all assessment related tasks including standardisation, moderation, marking, providing written and oral feedback, and submitting results fully, adhering to set deadlines.
- Develop professionally by participating with professionalism in the teacher developmental observation scheme and peer-observation scheme to ensure good practice. Monitor, self-evaluate and revise current teaching practice through reflection, collaboration with colleagues, and invitation of student feedback.
- Complete all course administrative tasks including records of work, attendance and end of course reports accurately and in a timely manner.
- Work effectively as part of a team to ensure the sharing of knowledge, approaches and materials to the benefit of students, teachers and the department.
- Adhere to all UCL and government policies relating to terms of employment, codes of professional conduct, Health and Safety, Equality, Diversity and Inclusion, Accessibility Regulations 2018, copyright legislation etc.

GUEST LECTURER | LONDON COLLEGE OF COMMUNICATION AT UNIVERSITY ARTS LONDON | JUNE 2025

- Delivered a lecture to undergraduate media students - "Stories of fame, race and gender in India (Celebrity and brand endorsements in Bollywood)".

SESSIONAL EAP TUTOR | KAPLAN INTERNATIONAL COLLEGE LONDON | JAN 2025 - PRESENT

- Delivers up to 20 hours of Academic Skills Teaching including Extended Projects, Research Projects and Critical Thinking for Academic Writing, as well as Foundation Certificate and Pre-Master's Teaching a week.
- Takes active part in a variety of teaching activities, including active learning, workshops, laboratory sessions, online support through VLE, project-focusses and other Applied Learning tasks, as well as more traditional lectures and seminars.
- Conducts various forms of formative and summative assessment while providing high-quality, actionable feedback to students in group and individual settings.
- Assists students in the development of their e-Portfolio.
- Participates in standardisation and moderation processes, including double-marking.
- Maintains an accurate and up-to-date record of student attendance and performance.

PRE-SESSIONAL EAP TUTOR | UNIVERSITY OF MANCHESTER | JUL 2024 – SEP 2024

- Prepared and delivered stimulating academic literacy and EAP synchronous on-line classes to undergraduate and post-graduate students using Ms Office and Zoom.
- Supported and guided students through group and individual academic tutorials by identifying individuals' strengths and areas for improvement on a weekly basis. Under her mentorship, a student received an excellence and teamwork award (out of 2000 students).
- Liaised with other teachers on lesson planning and provided them with professional IT support when needed. Troubleshot IT issues at short notice under pressure.
- Built exceptional student satisfaction scores by interacting with students inside and outside of the classroom and adhering to taking part in continuous professional development. Received exceptional feedback from a senior member of staff during an observation. Received praise for being able to convey complex information clearly.
- Assessed student performance, double-marking, and maintained accurate records to meet strict deadlines.

ESL TEACHER | EF EDUCATION FIRST (MANCHESTER, CAMBRIDGE AND LONDON) | MAY 2023 – DEC 2024

- Collaborated with colleagues across the UK to develop and deliver an original Social Media syllabus to pre-University students. The completed syllabus was then acquired and bought by EF Education First.
- Delivered engaging lessons and lectures to international students using innovative methods and digital tools, including Zoom, Teams, GoogleMeets, Quizlet, Memrise, Google Classroom, Jamboard, ChatGPT, Canva, Kahoot, Bamboozle, Wordwall, Twee and others.
- Conducted qualitative research, combined data and designed teacher training sessions on specific
- learning needs.
- Planned classes and maintained accurate administrative records. Set and marked classwork through a variety of different mediums and working with students with various SPLD and SEND needs (including dyslexia, ADHD, autism, blindness, social anxiety, depression).

- Took charge of the delivery of the Academic Writing, Critical Thinking, Media and Journalism and Business English lessons to pre-University and professional students alongside General English and Special Interest Classes.
- Liaised with other team members to provide last-minute cover while maintaining a Student Satisfaction Score within the top 3 teachers in EF London and Manchester.

ESL TEACHER | ENGLISH CITY | JAN 2023 – APR 2023

- Liaised with members of the team to provide UK University application advice and conducted Cambridge exam preparation courses and mock exams (through facilitation and marking).
- Provided last-minute cover and ensured all administrative tasks were completed.
- Supported teachers with IT issues when needed.

FILM APPRECIATION MENTOR | TAP INDIA | ONLINE | FEB 2021 – JUL 2021

- Collaborated internationally to deliver a film appreciation course to children aged 10-16 from underprivileged socio-economic backgrounds.
- Utilized Google Meets, Zoom, WhatsApp and various other digital tools to communicate with the international team in different time zones and delivered teaching project-based film appreciation sessions.

FREELANCE INTERPRETER AND ESL TEACHER | AA GLOBAL LANGUAGES AND ITALKI | JUL 2019 – SEP 2021

- Used a variety of online tools to deliver one-on-one English language lessons (Business and Academic) and provided UK University application guidance.
- Worked as a team and individually in social services and hospital settings to translate sensitive and confidential information in accordance with GDPR guidance.

ADMISSIONS ASSISTANT AND UNIVERSITY AMBASSADOR | UNIVERSITY OF WESTMINSTER | JUN 2014 – SEP 2015

- Communicated via phone, online and in person with various University departments to plan and provide workshops and events promoting the University on campus and online.
- Supported prospective home and international students in a 1:1 setting and provided them with effective and timely advice, support and guidance under pressure.

Film, media and event management work experience

TV PRESENTER AND ACTOR | FREELANCE | JUL 2016 – JUN 2019

- Acting credits include:
  - o *Hasmukh* | Netflix India
  - o *Vinted Poland Ad* by Choice Casting | Digital, Youtube Poland
  - o *Udan Patolas* | Amazon MiniTV
  - o *Karenjit Kaur – the Untold Story of Sunny Leone* | Zee 5
  - o *Innocent the Bhola* | Ullu
  - o *Savdhaan India – season 70 ep. 22 Atithi Devo Bhava* | Hotstar India
  - o *Midnights with Menka* directed by Malhar Thakkar
  - o *Painting on the Wall* | Thought Process Films
  - o 2 music videos for Zee Music with Shah Rule (*Legi Isse Kaise Tu*) and Ruchi J (*Rain Kari Kari*)

- Dance credits include:

o Rock On 2 live concert at the National Sports Club of India
o *Stardust Awards 2017* with Shah Rukh Khan
o Dancer at Isha Ambani's pre-wedding event in 2018
o *Jab Harry met Sejal, Mubarakan, Behen Hogi Teri, Guest iin London* background dancer
o Others including collaborations with Farah Khan, Ganesh Acharya, Geeta Kapur and Karishma Chavan

- TV Presenting credits include:
  o *Comedy Circus* | Sony Entertainment
  o *Telugu's Sixth Sense* | Hotstar India

- Modelling credits include:
  o Cover editorial pictures for a Pune magazine called Creme Magazine
  o Fashion shows for Manish Malhotra and Abu Jani

- Interviews include:
  o BBC Asian Network (with Mobeen Azhar - https://www.bbc.co.uk/sounds/play/p06nhryc)
  o Press in Polish (Gazeta.pl; TokFM radio broadcast and others)

EVENT MANAGEMENT | FREELANCE | JUL 2016 – JUN 2024

- The Warsaw Alo Cubano Festival (2024).
- The London Indian Film Festival (2014 & 2015).
  - Social media content creation, taking part in marketing activities around London and
- assisting at the event.
- The London BackUp Trust annual fashion show (2015).
  - Artist management and social media content creation.
- The London UK Coffee Week and Project Waterfall music festival (2016).
  - Event photography and social media content creation.

Other training/ Qualifications

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT | DEC 2022 - PRESENT | VARIOUS

UCL CPDs: Empowering Pre-sessional students as investigators of their own discipline; AI for Tutor Productivity (Jul 2025).

Webinar on dyslexia and specific learning difficulties in language teaching and learning at Lancaster University (Dec 2023).

EF CPDs: classroom management, DELTA training, Cambridge examination, mixed-abilities classes Institution (Ongoing).

Screenwriting course *Nieoczywisci Scenarzysci* in Cracow (Jul 2020).

Activities and Interests

Joanna's personal interests include storytelling through film, theater and playwriting, and she has completed various writing and acting workshops for those mediums. She is an avid reader, in particular of crime and psychological thrillers. She enjoys musical theater and thrift shopping. In her spare time, she

finds opportunities to travel through volunteering at international salsa and film festivals and continues to attend dance workshops in the UK, India, Poland and Spain.

References

Available upon request.

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